

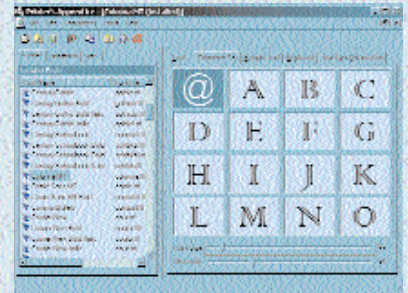
Managing Fonts

Once you've downloaded a massive album of fonts and typefaces, you're going to need some help in keeping them neatly arranged and organised. Printers Apprentice is a comprehensive tool for managing font files on Windows systems. Features include an Explorer-style interface for viewing fonts on your system, the ability to view fonts from any media without installing them, the ability to view character sets and keyboard layouts, batch font install/uninstall, and more. You can print eight different font catalogues and font sample sheets, as well as the entire contents of a disk or CD.

Another useful tool for font management is FontAgent, a font utility for repair-

ing, organising, and maintaining font collections. It quickly finds all fonts and identifies corrupt, duplicate and unmatched fonts. With the click of a button, it moves all the problem fonts into a special folder and organises all the good fonts any way you want: in one folder, in alphabetical sub-folders, and more.

If you're looking for a way to browse through the fonts installed on your computer, there is a freeware solution for you. Fontastic is a font viewer with capabilities that your common font viewer lacks. It gives you the ability to preview fonts using text that you type and not some prepared text such as Aa, Bb or that jaded 'The



Printer's Apprentice is a power tool for managing font files and type faces

quick brown fox' text. You can scale a font up to 500 points and easily rotate through the fonts as you wish.

actions, extensions, modules, and more for Adobe Photoshop software.

www.extensis.com is another resource for professionals serious about design. The tools available here are not free—in fact, they cost quite a bit. But one look at these utilities and you might think you are looking at some commercial stand-alone software. Extensis' product line is comprised of plugins for a wide range of page layout and graphics design software such as QuarkXPress and Adobe PageMaker.



Visual appeal

Unlike the Web, just any picture or photograph will not do for offline publishing. As the printing process is extremely sensitive to the resolution of an image, a visual with at least 300 dpi (dots per inch) would be ideal to maintain the quality of the image. There are plenty of sites on the Net that offer attractive, high quality photographs and illustrations. Although earlier many of these image stockpiles were freely available, the downturn of the Internet economy forced a change on their business model, making the seeker bear the burden.

Among the lesser-known image portals is **www.eyewire.com** which features stock photography, illustrations, clip art, videos and more. Though their offerings are on the pricier side, the quality justifies purchase.

If you're on the hunt for product shots of consumer electronics, look up the manufacturer's home page and navigate your way to the Press section of the site. If that's not available, the option

would be to contact the public relations or marketing departments and ask them for an assortment of images which they are usually happy to provide.

Searching for images

If you're tired of expensive licensing fees for images, there are two other avenues that might have answers for you. The most popular search engines on the Web, Google and Altavista not only catalogue billions of Web pages, but also index images. Using these engines to search for images is quite similar to using them to hunt for Web pages. All you have to do is

click the Images tab just above the text box. Once the page is loaded, use the text box to search for images that suit your query. Google, for example, analyses text on a Web page adjacent to the image itself. It also takes into consideration the image caption and other factors to rightly determine the image content.

The drawback? Neither search engine can determine whether the images being displayed are copyrighted material or not. If you see an image that you like and wish to use, open the Web page of the image to verify its exact status. Copyrighted images would require the authorisation of the

Royalty Blues

Sometimes, clarity is hard to find amid all the verbal gymnastics that image repository sites such as Corbis and Imagebank, the leaders in stock photography carry. At first glance, the term 'royalty-free' might appear to suggest that an image is free, with no strings attached. Well, you couldn't be further from the truth. We've elaborated on a few terms and their implications.

What the expression 'royalty-free' really means is you can use such images without having to pay for them on a per-use basis. But to get the images, you have to shell out a one-time fee that can range from tens to hundreds of dollars depending on the photograph and its resolution. Images that are classified under the royalty-free license can be altered and freely used in a wide variety of commercial purposes.

A traditional license requires you to outline how and when you wish to use the images and the fees will be based upon such information. Under this scheme, images are generally used only once, though deals can be arranged for time bound or unlimited usage. Of course, the more control you want over the images, the more you're going to have to pay. You can also request exclusive rights to an image, and although you won't own it, at least you can keep your competitors at bay. Sites such as Gettyimages use a similar method of licensing called 'rights & clearance' wherein a deal is negotiated between the site and the creator of the images on your behalf. Usually, clearance like this is required only in special circumstances outside the realm of ordinary license schemes.